

Monthly Protection Overview – March 2024 – Ethiopia

Part 1

Attacks on civilians <i>(including humanitarian workers and civilian infrastructures/facilities)</i>	Amhara	- The ongoing armed conflict may have affected civilians in their physical integrity as reported by some humanitarian actors but so far, no clear information has been collected by the cluster on IDPs in camps and sites. Road movements are still limited due to security risks. Owners of private truck fear having their vehicles being commandeered or taken away by armed men. That impacts seriously all logistic arrangements including humanitarian supply chains.
	Somali	New clashes between Afar-Somali communities have been reported in Siti zone. No further details on casualties and or displacement were shared so far.
New displacements <i>(specify the reason for displacement)</i>	Amhara	No new displacement was reported in the reporting period. But according to information collected by the North Shewa PC, 39 individuals who previously returned to Oromia would have reportedly come back to Debre Berhan.
	Oromia	Western Oromia: Due to cross-regional conflict over the last few days (21-22 March 2024) into Sassiga woreda of the East Wollega zone, an estimated 200 HHs (1757 individuals) have been displaced. These IDPs are currently located in collective sites in Sassiga woreda. According to the DRMO (Busa Gonofa-BG), a significant number of shelters have been destroyed and the BG office requested humanitarian assistance.
	Tigray	- New Influx of IDPs - ongoing new displacement from western and eastern Tigray due to drought and security reasons. - Continuous high flow of refugee returnees from Sudan, in need of assistance from the government and humanitarian organizations. So far in Tigray 2623 HH/6976 individuals have been registered in the Kobo tool and 1096 HHs/2708 individuals are returnees with only immigration entry ID cards registered in the Excel sheet.
Returns, relocations and durable solutions	Amhara	The Amhara authorities in coordination with federal officials, have resumed the return process. The PC Coordination and UNHCR in Debre Berhan, reported that return registration is ongoing. The aim being to empty the two remaining IDP camps in the city and keep Bakelo as the only IDP camp in Debre Berhan. The Amhara PC has informed OCHA in order to engage with the DRMC.
	Somali	In Afder zone, flood affected households were relocated in specific areas such as schools and colleges. Core relief items and multipurpose cash were supported during relocation. IDPs were returned to their original position after they gained support and better physical access in some areas.
	Tigray	Based on the intention survey conducted by CCCM cluster IDPs in Endabaguna and Shire, some IDPs would be willing to relocate to the Mai Dimu IDP site. Clusters articulated their capacity for the

		relocation and stated the costed plan/proposal to support the relocation of IDPs to Mai-Dimu site for advocacy for HCT and ICCG at the national level. There are threats of forceful eviction of IDPs from the IDP sites as reported by Freweini, and Quiha Bulecket factory. (source: CCCM cluster)
Socio-economic developments <i>(if applicable)</i>	Oromia	East/West Hararghe: - The price of grains has increased but the price of livestock has declined drastically - The job opportunities near IDP sites are nonexistent especially during the Ramadan fasting season Child marriage, child labor and begging are used as coping mechanism by IDPs Labor migration of 51,304 persons reported by East Hararghe Zonal DRMO in 10 woredas because of the food insecurity and rising cost of living.
	Somali	Food insecurity, high prices inflation, and insufficient food assistance remain critical challenges resulting in the increase of family separation, school dropout, children begging, child labour to contribute to household income generation, including young/adolescent girls moving to urban areas to work.
	Tigray	The African Union hosted a strategic review of the implementation of the Pretoria Cessation of Hostilities Agreement between the Government of Ethiopia and the TPLF.
Drought/flood highlights <i>(if applicable)</i>	Oromia	East/West Hararghe: In Belg, rain is delayed by a more than a month. As a result, farmers are not able to start belg production. This will in turn impact the food security in the area and recovery from last years' production loss.
	Somali	Sitti and Fafan zones are experiencing an intense drought that is negatively impacting communities. The main problem is a lack of water; therefore, many people move close to areas with boreholes and valleys to get water. - Most people consume unsafe water. Currently, the water situation is reported to be critical in most parts of the Siti zone, particularly on the western side of the zone including Afdem, Ma'eyso, Erer, Dhunyar, Daymeed, and Gablalu Woredas. - Among the existing IDPs, single mothers and women headed households have difficulties in supporting their children because they are unable to leave the site to look for work and have no spouse to support them.
	Tigray	Limited access to agricultural inputs vegetable, cereal, and pasture seeds is a significant challenge, as these seeds are essential for the upcoming Belg and Meher seasons.

Access to fundamental rights and basic services

Item	Please use the drop-down menu	Please briefly explain
Did the access situation by protection actors to affected population improved, remained similar or deteriorated? (compared with the last reporting period)	Access situation improved	Somali: No difficulties/obstacles reported
	Access situation remained similar	Amhara: There is no improvement in the access situation by humanitarian actors. Security risks coupled with the road trip limitation measure taken by the government is preventing humanitarian actors from reaching the populations in need.

		East/West Hararghe Tigray: The access situation remained similar Western Oromia: The access situation in the Wollega AoR remains similar as some woredas are accessible, partially accessible, and with hard-to-reach woredas as well such as Haro Limu, Ebentu, Amuru, Dano, Jibat, Nono, Abuna Gindeberet, Dera Woredas
	Access situation deteriorated	/
Please list and explain the most critical barriers for protection actors to access to affected population	On-going insecurity or hostilities affecting humanitarian assistance (incl. presence of ERWs)	Amhara Western Oromia
	Environmental and logistical constraints	Somali: Population in hard-to-reach areas have not been supported
	Other, please specify	East/West Hararghe: Lack of partner and funding. The number of protection partners and area of coverage is diminishing. Tigray: Funding shortages or delays in funding disbursement have impacted the implementation of protection programs and services and limited the scope and reach of interventions. The lack /delay of food aid, limited access to Identity cards, delay of return exercise, weak referral, the ongoing drought, and other livelihood challenges, have heightened vulnerabilities for IDPs, HC, and refugee returnees from Sudan, increasing the need for protection services and support.
Did the access situation for affected populations to protection services improved, remained similar, or deteriorated? (compared with the last reporting period)	Access situation improved	Somali: As the floods subsided, partners easily can access and implement projects.
	Access situation remained similar	Amhara: The explanation given above applies as limitation of access by humanitarian actors prevents affected populations from accessing humanitarian aid East/West Hararghe Western Oromia
	Access situation deteriorated	/
Please list and explain the most critical barriers for affected populations to access protection services:	Ongoing insecurity or hostilities	Amhara Western Oromia
	Unavailability of protection services	East/West Hararghe Somali: Zones such as Erer, Nogob, Doolo, Korahey and Jarar remain with zero/limited protection partners.
	Other, please specify	Benishangul Gumuz:
	OCHA	Amhara

With whom has the Protection Cluster/AoR consistently engaged on access for protection (during this reporting period)?		Tigray: The forum is functional under OCHA leadership where all humanitarian partners are engaged in information exchanges and production of access mapping and issues related to negotiation.
	UN Agencies	East/West Hararghe
	Coordination forum (e.g. Access WG, CM Coord, other)	Western Oromia
	Others (please specify)	Somali: Regional authorities, UN, INGOs/LNGOs, coordination, WGs

Service/need	Region/woreda(s)	Population affected	Relevant changes during the month in the access to fundamental right / basic service and impact on the affected population
Access to Justice (incl. HLP dispute resolutions)	Somali		• IDPs relocated in different areas reported fear of evictions specially Tog-Wajale, claim by host community on the land, land for settlement only considered while land for grassing and farming is not considered. IDPs have no ownership documentations/entitlements as well. • HLP documentation gaps • Weaker tenure • Limited access to justice
Child Protection services	Tigray	IDPs and host communities	• 227 (missed) children from the spontaneously reunified 300 children are traced and verified by BOSAR and CP AoR partners. • Expected increase in child protection risks due to: High number of school dropouts; Severe food and water shortage; Health risks • Funding Shortages for Child Protection partners • Need for rapid response mechanisms to address the needs of children in drought-affected districts. • Lack of Child-Friendly Space (CFS) supplies, including tents and recreational kits • There is a high number of children begging on the streets, especially around IDP sites. • Need for capacity-building training on Mental Health and Psychosocial Support (MHPSS) and Case Management for Government and NGO actors.
Civil documentation	Tigray	IDPs and host communities	• EECMY/UNHCR officially started the legal aid service in Abi-Adi town and Shraro as of March 2024. • EECMY/UNHCR signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with Mekelle University to provide legal aid services for IDPs and IDP returnees starting from March 2024. • Mekelle: IDPs residing in Quiha are unable to receive identity cards.

Civil documentation	Somali		- The issue of civil documentation, especially IDs, has been highlighted several times as IDPs lack access to national IDs. Essential services such as movement and access to banking systems, while the wider HLP issues remain critical. The Government (DRMB/ENDRMC) has now confirmed the roll-out of national ID for some IDPs and will be piloted in Adadle IDP site. The cluster stressed lack of partners and funding. - In addition, IDPs are living in poor congested shelters with no privacy, exposing them to protection risks. The plastic sheets in some sites have worn out and have holes. The shelters are too small to accommodate the growing family size.
Education	Tigray		- An estimated 230,000 students are impacted by drought and at risk of dropping out and few school closures reported in the Eastern Zone (Source: Education cluster). - Most Schools resumed in the presence of IDPs – Only 06 Schools out of 71 School IDP sites are emptied via Return and Relocation.
Food and nutrition	Oromia / East and West Hararghe zones	All IDPs in site	With the drastic reduction of food assistance beneficiaries and no allocation of JEOP assistance it is highly unlikely that the IDPs will receive food assistance.
Food and nutrition	Somali / Fafan and Siti zones	450,000 people	58 kebeles need emergency water trucking for 450,000 people (76,219 HHs). 38% of the boreholes are not working and are contributing to the impact. 75% of the population did not have access to enough food due to the agricultural production failure, the livestock condition was worsening, and no market for animals, and the growing cost of the staple food. There are at least 260,000 people in the Fafan zone who need emergency food after they face a critical shortage of food. There are impacts on livestock including the lack of access to the livestock market, the scarcity of water and medical supplies, and the shortage of feed.
Food and nutrition	Tigray	IDPs and host communities/ the whole community	- Due to limited resources, partners are prioritizing the most food-insecure woredas and IDPs within the IDP sites, avoiding IDPs living in the host community. - Women and girls are disproportionately impacted by the effects of displacement and the dire economic situation, resulting in many women and girls adopting negative coping mechanisms such as transactional sex and child marriage.
GBV core services	Tigray	IDPs and host communities	- Tigray Region continues to be impacted by substantial displacement and exacerbated GBV risks, including harmful social norms such as stigma, victim/survivor-blaming, and isolation. - Overcrowded Safe Houses because survivors at the safe houses cannot be reintegrated into their communities due to fear and harmful social norms.

			• Rape, sexual assault, and intimate partner violence were reported as the highest incidents • Limited livelihood and IGA interventions. • Challenges to accountability and access to justice for survivors
Health services	Oromia / East and West Hararghe zones	All IDPs in site	Cholera remains a concern, with a total of 699 cases and 6 deaths reported in 17 woredas in East Hararghe zone and 92 cases of Cholera reported in 6 woredas in West Hararghe zone, resulting in 2 death. Limited WASH partners, shortage of cholera medications and water treatment chemicals are contributing to the spread of Cholera.
Health services	Tigray	IDPs	Many youths in Seba kare are exposed to and using drugs and different substances; there is also a tendency to migrate.
Land marking and clearance form ERWs	Tigray		• Accreditation for MA Partners has not yet been granted. • RADO who was active in mine action activities has phased out due to lack of budget
Shelter/NFI	Tigray	IDPs and host communities	• High demand for dignity kits and hygiene materials. • Weak referral response due to budget shortage even though there is a need for NFIs, medication, dignity kits, and sanitary materials.

Part 2

AoR/WG	Child Protection (CP)
Main Achievements	• 173 UASC (96 girls , 67 boys and 10 undefined gender) have been reunited with extended family members or placed in alternative care arrangement during Feb. • In Dasench district, a total of 520 (250 girls & 270 boys) vulnerable children, including children with disabilities, unaccompanied and separated children (UASC), child-headed households, and children with multiple protection concerns, received multipurpose cash support. Each child was provided with 2,500 ETB to meet their immediate needs, ensuring their survival, protection, and overall well-being. • In Amhara, efforts have been focused on strengthening CP case management, which will be further intensified with the re-deployment of 135 social service workforce Child Protection Case Workers (CSWs) and the existing 45 (39-M, 6-F) Mental Health and Psychosocial Support (MHPSS) professionals stationed across different crisis-affected zones.
Underserved locations	• IDP children in west Gojjam and other recently conflicted impacted zones and woredas • The most vulnerable children in Sasiga Woreda, particularly those who reside in the Balo, Angar, and Bareda kebele, are highly in need of emergency food assistance and medical attention. Furthermore, the situation of children and women in Alibo IDP sites needs attention for basic needs and psychosocial support.
Additional information	• UNICEF's DED, Ted Chaiban, has issued a pressing call to action to the international community, urging immediate escalation of support for children and families in Ethiopia to prevent a deepening humanitarian crisis across the country. DED made this plea during his visit to the Tigray region, where malnutrition rates have soared beyond the emergency threshold.
Main findings (from assessment, protection)	<u>Urgent support required for returnees in Konso zone (SER):</u> • Since 2022, a total of 47,741 IDPs (6,807 HHs; close to 90% of the initial 53,697 IDPs) have spontaneously returned to Segen Zuria (70%) and Karat Zuria (30%) woredas previously affected by inter-communal conflicts since 2020; at least

monitoring, surveys conducted during the reporting period)	11,443 IDPs (1,382 HHs or 21%) of those have returned in the last six months only. While the return is reportedly safe and voluntary, it cannot be considered dignified. Urgent support is required to address at least some of the severe gaps in this multi-crises and top-priority zone, as determined in a multi-sectoral assessment of key return areas (February 2024), partner reports, and the most recent OCHA and P2P visits with all-stakeholder consultations and direct observations in February and March 2024. Protection response scale-up is urgently needed to ensure coordinated response to sexual and gender-based violence (SGBV), mental health and psycho-social support (MHPSS) and child protection (CP), including community mobilization (starting with re-establishment of communal coordination structures), awareness-raising, capacity building, accountability mechanisms, child/women-friendly spaces, UASC family tracing and reunification etc. This is conscious of the frequent SGBV incidents (especially during water fetching; sometimes with extreme outcomes including suicide), persistent trauma and anxiety of crises-affected people, and a high number of children out of school (due to e.g. lack of clothes, sanitation, scholastic materials, alternative care, as well as due to child labour and child/forced marriages). Peacebuilding and social cohesion interventions are considered important (by all stakeholders) to sustain the generally good security situation.
Relevant links (if any)	Joint multi-sectoral needs assessment report of Konso zone

Part 3

Coordination mechanisms and outcomes for the reporting period

Cluster/AoR presence/functioning	East/West Hararghe: March 11 East Hararghe protection cluster; March 13 West Hararghe protection cluster
Protection monitoring	East/West Hararghe: UNHCR with protection cluster members is conducting Protection monitoring in 6 woredas of East and West Hararghe zones. IOM, IMC, IRC and UNHCE are currently conducting the data collection. Somali: With the support of UNHCR information management SESEDA/UNHCR have conducted 2 protection monitoring (drought and flood) in 12 IDP sites of Hargelle, Barey and Dolo bay woredas. SESEDA protection team conducted 10 monthly protection coordination meetings where zonal administration, woreda administrations as well as humanitarian partners have actively participated to share the ongoing protection interventions in the zone. SESEDA protection team designed a referral pathway document that based on the need of GBV survivors as well as PWNs. In the reporting period a total of 600 people were linked with humanitarian services. 225 PWN have been referred internally whereas the remaining 375 have been referred to humanitarian partners including OWDA in Hargelle, Islamic Relief in Barey and Health Poverty Action in Dolobay woreda Tigray: OCHA/ICCG-led joint monitoring has been conducted in the drought-affected areas in the Eastern Zone of Tigray (Hawzen, Adigrat, Subha Saesie, Gerealta, Erob, Tsirae Wemerta) from 6 -10 February 2024, the report has been finalized
Relevant documents	East/West Hararghe: Durable solutions working group inter agency assessment by UNHCR, IOM, DRMO and endorsed by the East Hararghe Zonal DRMO DSWG joint need assessment finding re

Working Groups, Task Forces, collaborations	• East/West Hararghe: Oromia Regional ICCG biweekly meeting • Somali: Afder zone protection working group meeting • Tigray: Emergency Coordination Center (ECC Tigray Region); ICCG; Bi-weekly PC Coordination Meeting; Child Protection AoR; Mine Action AoRs; GBV AoR; Housing, Land and Property Technical WG; Disability/Inclusion Technical working group	• Somali: Protection coordination meeting to share the ongoing protection interventions in the zone with active participation of the zonal administration, woreda administration as well as humanitarian partners. The main outcomes of these meetings were mapping of protection actors, avoiding duplication of resources and as well as linking of SESEDA identified PWN to the services that these partners are providing. Islamic Relief in Barey, Pastoralist Concern and Health Poverty Action are the main protection actors that SESEDA have been collaborating with. • Tigray: In addition to the regular meetings, PC has been involved in Ad-hoc forums, contributing significantly to raising protection concerns and drawing the attention of other cluster leads and partners. Since the establishment of UNHCR FU's in three locations, PC continues to liaise with the Zonal Coordination structure and maintain strong linkages to tag field-level protection services, gaps, and priorities.
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